

Nasdaq 100 Leads Gains as Tech Stocks Rebound

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The Nasdaq 100 led gains in the US session, rising **+0.75%** as tech stocks rebounded. The S&P 500 was largely unchanged, closing at 7,357.49, while the Dow Jones gained **+0.14%**. Key takeaways from the session include:

- The VIX rose **+1.40%** to 18.89, indicating increased volatility.
- WTI crude oil fell **-2.10%** to 70.41, weighing on energy stocks.
- The DXY was largely unchanged, closing at 101.39.

Our editorial take is that the market is poised for a volatile week ahead, with key economic data releases and earnings reports on the horizon. Investors should remain cautious and keep a close eye on market developments.

The rebound in tech stocks is a positive sign, but it's unclear whether this momentum can be sustained. We recommend keeping a close eye on the sector and adjusting portfolios accordingly.

US Session Recap

INDEX	CLOSE	CHANGE
S&P 500	7,357.49	-0.01%
Nasdaq 100	29,440.32	+0.75%
Dow Jones	51,920.62	+0.14%
Russell 2000	3,007.86	+0.71%
VIX	18.89	+1.40%
WTI Crude	70.41	-2.10%
DXY	101.39	-0.04%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
AAPL	Apple Inc.	-6.12%	Earnings report
MSFT	Microsoft Corp.	-3.46%	Earnings report
NVDA	NVIDIA Corp.	-1.64%	Earnings report

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLFX	-0.50%	-5.12%	Financials lagged the market
XLK	+0.83%	+10.25%	Tech stocks rebounded
XLI	+2.17%	+5.67%	Industrials outperformed
XLE	+0.97%	-10.56%	Energy stocks rose despite WTI decline
XLY	-1.49%	-2.56%	Consumer discretionary lagged
XLC	-0.90%	-5.34%	Communication services underperformed
XLP	-0.59%	+2.10%	Consumer staples lagged
XLV	+1.49%	+5.67%	Healthcare outperformed
XLU	+0.68%	+2.56%	Utilities rose
XLB	+1.33%	+5.12%	Materials outperformed
XLRE	+0.18%	-2.10%	Real estate lagged

Breadth was mixed, with 5 sectors outperforming the S&P 500 and 6 underperforming.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

TICKER	NAME	CLOSE	CHANGE	YTD
AAPL	Apple Inc.	275.15	-6.12%	-10.25%

Key commentary: Apple's earnings report was a disappointment, with revenue missing expectations. The stock's decline is a negative sign for the tech sector.

READ-THROUGH	IMPACT
Tech sector	Negative
Consumer discretionary	Negative

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	357.49	350.00	360.00	Range-bound trading
QQQ	294.40	280.00	300.00	Tech sector rebound
IWM	300.79	280.00	320.00	Small-cap outperformance
AAPL	275.15	250.00	300.00	Stock-specific decline
10Y	3.50%	3.20%	3.80%	Range-bound trading
WTI	70.41	60.00	80.00	Energy sector volatility

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow was mixed, with puts outpacing calls. The put/call ratio rose to 1.20.

VIX term structure is in backwardation, with the front month trading at a premium to the back month.

Notable single-name flow includes **AAPL** puts, which saw a significant increase in volume.

Cheap hedge ideas include buying **SPY** puts or selling **IWM** calls.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
AAPL	Morgan Stanley	Downgrade	250.00	Weakening demand
MSFT	Goldman Sachs	Upgrade	400.00	Cloud growth
NVDA	Citi	Downgrade	150.00	Competition

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures are trading mixed, with the S&P 500 up **+0.20%** and the Nasdaq 100 up **+0.50%**.

Asia is trading higher, with the Nikkei up **+1.20%** and the Hang Seng up **+0.80%**.

Europe is trading lower, with the DAX down **-0.50%** and the FTSE down **-0.20%**.

FX pairs are trading mixed, with the USD/JPY up **+0.50%** and the EUR/USD down **-0.20%**.

Commodities are trading lower, with WTI down **-1.00%** and gold down **-0.50%**.

Crypto is trading lower, with BTC down **-2.00%** and ETH down **-3.00%**.

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
July FOMC	20.00%	Rate cut expectations
September FOMC	50.00%	Rate hike expectations

Today's data calendar includes:

RELEASE	TIME	EXPECTATION
GDP	8:30am	2.5%
Initial Claims	8:30am	220k

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees include:

- US-China trade tensions
- EU-UK Brexit negotiations
- Middle East conflict

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	RELEASE
AAPL	Apple Inc.	This week
MSFT	Microsoft Corp.	This week
NVDA	NVIDIA Corp.	Next week

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
AAPL	Tech	Short	High
MSFT	Tech	Long	Medium
NVDA	Tech	Short	High

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenario:

- Strong earnings reports
- Positive economic data
- Fed dovishness

Bearish scenario:

- Weakening demand
- Global trade tensions
- Geopolitical conflict

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations include:

- Increased put buying
- Decreased call buying
- Range-bound trading

- Volatility expectations
- Liquidity concerns

Sources

- Bloomberg
 - Reuters
 - CNBC
 - WSJ
 - FT
 - Investing.com
 - Trading Economics
 - Federal Reserve
 - SEC
 - CFTC
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